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Build a deployable agent first

Make the full path work before adding more agent features.

Start with the path

The first milestone is not a perfect agent. It is a working path from question to backend, frontend, container, and deployment.

Keep version one small

A simple tool loop is enough for the first slice.
Add memory, vector search, and structured outputs after the deployed version works.

Streaming adds complexity

Structured outputs are useful, but combining them with streaming and tool events can make the first version harder to reason about.

Then improve the system

Once the vertical slice runs, add traces, tests, retrieval improvements, auth, and evaluation against a real workflow.

follow for practical AI engineering notes

Full recording: End-to-End Agent Deployment